

Most internal candidates assume being internal means being known.

It does not. Being internal means you have been in the building. That is different from being someone the hiring leader knows, trusts, and can picture in the role.

When a leadership role opens internally, the conversation has usually already happened. The leaders filling it know who they want before the posting goes live. The people they are thinking of are not the ones who applied when the role went up. They are the ones who showed up across the organization before anyone was watching.

The internal candidate who lost to an outside hire did not lose in the interview. They lost in every cross-team conversation they did not have, every problem outside their lane they did not step into, every moment they stayed where it was comfortable when the work crossed a boundary.

What does it mean about how we build careers inside our own companies if being "internal" is not actually the advantage most people think it is?

#leadership #techleadership #careergrowth #engineeringmanagement